Guidebooks

H 1645

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A. Background

The form subdivision ***--Guidebooks*** is used as a free-floating form subdivision for handbooks for travelers, sightseers, etc., containing information about routes, facilities and accommodations, items of interest, etc., that is, "how to get there and what to see and do" information. The related form subdivision ***--Tours*** is used as a free-floating subdivision for works providing planned itineraries. For guidelines on the topical subdivision ***--Description and travel***, see H 1530.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

B. Recent revisions

2026-02: Corrected typos.

C. Definitions

Guidebooks: resources for travelers, sightseers, etc., containing information about routes, facilities and accommodations, items of interest, etc., that is, "how to get there and what to see and do" information

D. General rule

Use ***--Guidebooks*** under appropriate subject headings for works containing information of interest to persons en route or in the field.

Use the subdivision only under subjects that have a connotation of place within them, thus allowing for the possibility of travel and viewing. For example, the subdivision may not be used under a discipline such as ***Economics*** since it has no connotation of place. It may, however, be used under a heading such as ***Geology*** for field guides to particular places.

Some works called "guides" may actually be representative of other forms of publications. If the "guide" is simply a textbook on a topic, no form subdivision is needed (see also H 2187). If it is a reference work, the form subdivision ***--Handbooks, manuals, etc.*** may be applicable (cf. H 1646). If it is a work describing methods for gaining practical experience through first-hand observation and collection of data, the topical subdivision ***--Fieldwork*** may be appropriate.

LC practice: For resources that contain information of interest to travelers to a place, assign subject headings for the topic, place, etc., that is the focus of the travel. Assign the LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Guidebooks***. This instruction applies to sections E-I below.

E. Types of authorized headings

Use ***--Guidebooks*** under the following types of headings:

- Place names, and named geographic entities such as parks, archaeological sites, etc.
- Types of lands, land uses, geographic features, etc., such as gardens, resorts, refuges, trails, rivers, etc.
- Structures, buildings, institutions, including both named entities and types of the same
- Types of architecture
- Activities involving travel in the field, for example, agriculture, backpacking, bird watching, geology, hiking, mountaineering, viticulture, fishing, etc.
- Art and antiquities, including specific art genres
- Classes of persons and ethnic groups followed by the subdivision ***--Travel***

F. Place names

Use the subdivision ***--Guidebooks*** directly following a particular place name.

Examples:

```
651 #0 $a Baltimore (Md.) $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Baltimore (Md.)
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft
```

```
651 #0 $a Hawaii $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Hawaii.
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft
```

```
651 #0 $a Blue Ridge Mountains $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Blue Ridge Mountains.
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft
```

G. Named entities

Use ***--Guidebooks*** directly under the name of the individual entity for guides to named parks, reserves, roads, battlefields, institutions, and other named lands.

Example:

```
651 #0 $a Yellowstone National Park $v Guidebooks.
651 #0 $a Martin's Hundred Site (Va.) $v Guidebooks.
610 20 $a Library of Congress $v Guidebooks.
610 20 $a Harvard University $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Yellowstone National Park.
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft
```

```
651 #0 $a Martin's Hundred Site (Va.)
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft
```

```
610 20 $a Library of Congress.
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft

610 20 $a Harvard University.
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft
```

H. Topical headings

When using ***--Guidebooks*** under locally subdivided topical headings, make an additional entry, also subdivided by ***--Guidebooks***, either under the corresponding place name, or under the entity, such as a park, used as the local subdivision.

LC practice: For resources that contain information of interest to travelers related to a specific topic, assign subject headings for both the ***[topic]--Place*** and the ***[place]***. If there is a specific focus on the type of travel or tourism, also assign a subject heading for that type of travel or tourism. Assign the LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Guidebooks***.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Cemeteries $z New England $v Guidebooks.
651 #0 $a New England $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Cemeteries $z New England.
651 #0 $a New England.
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft

650 #0 $a Lakes $z California $z Sierra National Forest $v Guidebooks.
651 #0 $a Sierra National Forest (Calif.) $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Lakes $z California $z Sierra National Forest.
651 #0 $a Sierra National Forest (Calif.)
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft

650 #0 $a White-water canoeing $z Québec (Province) $v Guidebooks.
651 #0 $a Québec (Province) $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a White-water canoeing $z Québec (Province)
651 #0 $a Québec (Province)
```

```
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft


650 #0 $a Mountaineering $z Colorado $z Rocky Mountain National Park $v
       Guidebooks.
651 #0 $a Rocky Mountain National Park (Colo.) $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Mountaineering $z Colorado $z Rocky Mountain National Park.
651 #0 $a Rocky Mountain National Park (Colo.)
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft


650 #0 $a Historic buildings $z Pennsylvania $z Philadelphia $v Guidebooks.
651 #0 $a Philadelphia (Pa.) $v Guidebooks.
651 #0 $a Philadelphia (Pa.) $x Buildings, structures, etc. $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Historic buildings $z Pennsylvania $z Philadelphia.
651 #0 $a Philadelphia (Pa.)
651 #0 $a Philadelphia (Pa.) $x Buildings, structures, etc.
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft


650 #0 $a Painting $z France $z Paris $v Guidebooks.
651 #0 $a Paris (France) $v Guidebooks.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Painting $z France $z Paris.
651 #0 $a Paris (France)
655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft
```

I. Tours

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Tours*** after names of places and corporate bodies for works providing planned itineraries for travelers in those places or visitors to those organizations.

LC practice: Assign subject headings for names of places and corporate bodies for works providing planned itineraries for travelers in those places or visitors to those organizations. Also assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, i.e. LCGFT ***Guidebooks***.

Examples:

Title: 10 tours of Boston and Cambridge.

651 #0 $a Boston (Mass.) $v Tours.

651 #0 $a Cambridge (Mass.) $v Tours.

LC practice:

651 #0 $a Boston (Mass.)

651 #0 $a Cambridge (Mass.)

655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft

Title: Engstrom's guide to treasure tours of 278 masterpieces in the Louvre Museum.

610 20 $a Musée du Louvre $v Tours.

651 #0 $a Paris (France) $v Tours.

LC practice:

610 20 $a Musée du Louvre.

651 #0 $a Paris (France)

655 #7 $a Guidebooks. $2 lcgft

Revision history

2026-02: Corrected typos.

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.